

**CHAPTER xviii**

An Act to extend the time for the acquisition of lands by the Cheshire County Council and the Lancashire County Council under the Cheshire and Lancashire County Councils (Runcorn-Widnes Bridge &c.) Act 1947 and for other purposes.

[12th July 1950.]

WHEREAS—

(1) By the Cheshire and Lancashire County Councils 10 & 11 Geo. 6. (Runcorn-Widnes Bridge &c.) Act 1947 the county council. xxix. of the administrative county of the county palatine of Chester and the county council of the administrative county of the county palatine of Lancaster were authorised to construct a bridge for vehicular and pedestrian traffic over the river Mersey and the Manchester Ship Canal between the borough of Widnes in the county of Lancaster and the urban district of Runcorn in the county of Chester:

(2) It is provided by section 36 of the said Act that the powers granted by the said Act for the compulsory purchase of lands shall cease on the thirty-first day of December one thousand nine hundred and fifty:

(3) It is expedient that the said powers should be extended as by this Act provided:

(4) It is provided by section 27 of the said Act that if the bridge and the other works authorised by the said Act are not completed within ten years from the passing of the said Act then on the expiration of that period the powers granted for making and completing the bridge and other works or otherwise in relation thereto shall cease except as to so much thereof as is then completed:

(5) It is expedient that the said provision should be repealed as by this Act provided:

(6) The purposes of this Act cannot be effected without the authority of Parliament:

(7) In relation to the promotion of the Bill for this Act the said county councils have observed the requirements of Part 23 & 24 Geo. 5. XIII of the Local Government Act 1933: c. 51.

May it therefore please Your Majesty that it may be enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal and Commons in this present Parliament assembled and by the authority of the same as follows:—

Short title.

1. This Act may be cited as the Runcorn-Widnes Bridge Act 1950.

Interpretation.

2. In this Act—

“the Act of 1947” means the Cheshire and Lancashire County Councils (Runcorn-Widnes Bridge &c.) Act 1947;

“the Councils” means the county council of the administrative county of the county palatine of Chester and the county council of the administrative county of the county palatine of Lancaster or either of them as the case may be.

Extension of time.

3. The period limited by section 36 (Period for compulsory purchase of lands) of the Act of 1947 for the compulsory purchase of land for the purposes of that Act is hereby extended until the thirty-first day of December nineteen hundred and fifty-three.

Power to owners and lessees to give notice as to purchase of land.

4.—(1) If any person being the owner or lessee of any land which may be acquired compulsorily under the Act of 1947 shall desire that any such land or his interest therein shall be acquired as soon as may be and shall give notice in writing to the Councils of such desire the Councils within a period of three months after the receipt of such notice shall either enter into an effective contract with such person for the acquisition of such land or his interest therein by agreement or serve a notice to treat for the compulsory acquisition thereof or shall intimate their intention not to proceed with the purchase of such land.

(2) In any case in which the Councils notify their intention not to proceed with the purchase of any land the powers conferred by the Act of 1947 for the compulsory purchase of such land shall cease.

5. Section 27 (Period for completion of works) of the Act of Repeal, 1947 is hereby repealed.

6. The costs charges and expenses preliminary to and of and Costs of Act. incidental to the preparing applying for obtaining and passing of this Act as taxed by the taxing officer of the House of Lords or of the House of Commons shall be borne by the Councils in equal shares and shall be paid out of their respective county funds or out of moneys to be borrowed under the Act of 1947.

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